



Buruk fell to the floor after the incident, covering his face in pain and shock

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Mourinho accused of ‘physically attacking’ Galatasaray manager, Okan Buruk

Galatasaray have accused Fenerbahce boss Jose Mourinho of “physically attacking” their manager after he appeared to grab his nose following a fiery derby in the Turkish Cup

JOHN PAYNE

► Sukru Saracoglu Stadium

The incident occurred after the final whistle at Sukru Saracoglu Stadium, when both managers were interacting with the match officials in the centre circle.

Mourinho approached Buruk

from behind and appeared to pinch his nose, causing the Galatasaray manager to fall to the floor with his hands covering his face.

“Our manager Okan and Mourinho congratulated the referees. After that, while Okan was continuing, Mourinho first verbally and then physically attacked him,” Gal-

atasaray’s vice-president Metin Ozturk said.

“Where else in the world can he do this? What does he think of Turkey?... I believe that Fenerbahce’s management will impose the necessary sanction before the federation imposes them.”

Galatasaray won the Turkish Cup

quarter-final tie 2-1 with Victor Osimhen scoring twice for the visitors.

BBC Sport has contacted Fenerbahce for a response.

Buruk, who enjoyed two spells at Galatasaray as a player before returning as manager in 2022, played down the incident at his post-match news conference.

“There was nothing between me and Mourinho,” Buruk said.

“He pinched my nose from behind. There was a slight scratch. Of course, it wasn’t a very nice or elegant thing to do.

“We expect managers to behave more appropriately in such situations. I won’t exaggerate this issue, but it wasn’t a classy move.”

Fenerbahce substitute Mert Yandas and Galatasaray substitutes Kerem Demirbay and Baris Yilmaz were shown red cards for their part in a melee between the two benches during stoppage time.

Following a goalless draw between the two clubs in the Turkish Super Lig in February, Galatasaray said they would “initiate criminal proceedings” against Mourinho after claiming he made “racist statements”.

The Turkish Football Federation also handed Mourinho a four-game ban and a fine of £35,194 for two separate disciplinary matters.

Mourinho responded by launching a lawsuit against Galatasaray “due to the attack on the personal rights” of the Portuguese, after the club accused him of making racist statements.

The Fenerbahce manager was accused by Galatasaray of making racist statements after Monday’s Istanbul derby and, on Tuesday, the Portuguese’s Turkish club released a statement saying his comments had been taken “completely taken out of context”.

On Friday, Fenerbahce said Mourinho was filing a 1,907,000 Turkish Lira lawsuit, through the club’s lawyers, against Galatasaray “due to the attack on the personal rights” of the Portuguese coach.

The amount - which is worth around £41,000 - is symbolic as 1907 is the year Fenerbahce Sports Club was founded.

Speaking in the news conference after Monday’s 0-0 draw, Mourinho said the home bench had been “jumping like monkeys” and also repeated his criticism of Turkish referees, saying it would have been a “disaster” to use an official from the country. The match was then refereed by Slavko Vincic.



Yared Nuguse making the podium for USA after his performance in the 1500m

GETTY IMAGES

‘The Goose’ chases golds in long distance running before returning to dental school

HARRY POOLE

► Paris

Yared Nuguse’s childhood ambition has never changed.

While the 25-year-old made the podium in the fastest Olympic

men’s 1500m final in history, his dream since 13 has been to qualify as an orthodontist.

But world gold is the American’s target in 2025 as he builds towards a shot at Olympic glory in Los Angeles in 2028 - an achievement the

self-confessed ‘Swiftie’ hopes will grant him the opportunity to at last meet singer Taylor Swift.

The deadline for this chapter of his life has been set, however - Nuguse has no intention of delaying his career in dentistry beyond his 20s.

“I always said I will get back to dentistry. The goal is 2029 right now, so I’m going to enjoy these years of running while I have it,” Nuguse tells BBC Sport.

“When I had braces I was such a huge fan of my orthodontist. I now have a smile that I’m really proud of and that is something I would love to provide to a lot of other kids. You can give them this permanent confidence boost.

“I’d always been the nerdy, smart type and I’d just pointed everything towards getting into dentist school. Running was just this fun little side thing.”

Nuguse never saw himself as the sporty type. At high school, he joined the bowling team to satisfy his extracurricular requirements, as it seemed “a great way to be in sport without being in a sport”.

The admissions tests were completed, the offers from dental schools were in.

But everything changed on the day his PE teacher informed the school’s track coach of his talent - an intervention which led Nuguse to rethink his plans and, ultimately, claim Olympic bronze in one of the most eagerly anticipated events of Paris 2024.

Nuguse, who also won world in-

“Yared Nuguse thanked Taylor Swift and his pet tortoise Tyro in a social media post after winning Olympic bronze in Paris,”

door silver last year, has asserted himself as a key player in a men’s 1500m event that has captured widespread attention amid the rivalry between Josh Kerr and Jakob Ingebrigtsen.

But as Kerr and Ingebrigtsen engaged in a public war of words last year, Nuguse was happy to leave the spotlight to his competitors and enjoy the fallout from afar.

“There’s already a lot of pressure on all of us but at the Olympics there was a little more on them, and a little less on me,” says Nuguse.

“I did love going to practice earlier in the year and it was like ‘oh my God, did you hear what they said?’ It’s the juiciest running drama we’ve had in a long time.

“It is a little funny how serious it felt in the moment. You can’t focus on it too much because it’s their business, but it made good running

conversation, that’s for sure.”

Nuguse beat defending champion Ingebrigtsen and finished within 0.15 seconds of gold in a dramatic Paris final, in which Cole Hocker squeezed past Britain’s world champion Kerr to win in an Olympic record time.

The event’s current heavyweights represent four of the nine fastest men in history over the distance, but Nuguse is the only one yet to get his hands on gold.

He believes this year’s World Championships in Tokyo will provide his crowning moment.

“You’re really happy and proud of yourself but, at the same time, you’re still yearning for more,” says Nuguse, who broke the indoor mile world record in February only to see Ingebrigtsen beat it five days later.

“I know I can win these races, I was right there with them. It’s just a matter of doing literally that last 1%, or 0.1%.

“It just feels like it’s my time. I can taste it, I’m so close.”

Before aiming for his first global title in September, Nuguse will compete in the inaugural season of Michael Johnson’s Grand Slam Track, which begins in Kingston, Jamaica on Friday.

As a contracted racer, he will line up against fellow Olympic medalists Hocker and Kerr over 800m and 1500m at four ‘slams’, with a total prize pot of \$12.6m (£10m) on offer to athletes, in addition to a base salary.

However, Johnson’s controversial decision to exclude field events from the competition has been criticised.

“Track doesn’t really have this pinnacle league like a lot of other sports do and it’s largely because our sport is so different to a lot of traditional sports.

“It would be nice for track athletes to be treated like athletes in other professional sports, especially at the top level.

“I think it’s definitely a good shot at making something that could last

and promote more of a professional league. I’m very interested to see how it’s received but [Johnson] seems to be doing everything right.”

Nuguse’s pet tortoise Tyro has only been out of hibernation for a few days when we speak, but the laid-back athlete is grateful to have his companion back.

“The irony was a big part of it. I often joke that he absorbs all my slow energy for me, so that I can be as fast as I want,” says Nuguse.

It will likely not be long before he once again becomes the star of the American’s social media accounts, providing an outlet for Nuguse’s silliness without having to be the main focus himself.

Behind him, a sign on the door reads ‘Beware of Goose’, after a high school news article coined the phrase ‘the Goose is loose’ as his running talent became increasingly apparent - and his team-mates ensured the nickname stuck.

This journey was not one Nuguse ever expected, the attention it has

PARIS 2024 ATHLETICS MEN’S 1500M RESULTS

RANK	TEAM	PARTICIPANT	RESULTS
1	USA	Cole HOCKER	3:27.65
2	GBR	Josh KERR	3:27.79
3	USA	Yared NUGUSE	3:27.80

SOURCE: OLYMPICS.COM MICHAL KOSNIK

brought unnatural. He always had another plan.

But his self-imposed deadline in the sport - before embarking on four years of dental school and a further two years of specialisation - is only serving to enhance his enjoyment of this current assignment.

“Hopefully, if I win Olympic gold, I’d probably like to do a bit of 2029 as a little victory lap, or a

year where I just do fun races,” says a proud Nuguse.

“Running is something that I love so much and has brought me so much joy, but it’s not something you can do forever. Life is too short for that.”

“Having a deadline, you know you have to enjoy these years because you’re going to blink and, the next thing you know, it’s all over.”



Man City’s Grealish honours late brother with goal after 2-0 win over Leicester OLI SCARFF / AFP

Grealish dedicates winning goal to late brother

SIMON STONE

► Etihad Stadium

“That was for you, Keelan” - An emotional Jack Grealish dedicated his first Premier League goal in almost 16 months to his younger brother Keelan on the 25th anniversary

of his death. On his first league start since December, the Manchester City midfielder scored a second-minute opener in the 2-0 win against Leicester at Etihad Stadium.

As he celebrated, it seemed Grealish was simply happy at marking a rare start with an even rarer league goal, ending a long wait since the 2-2 draw with Crystal Palace on 16 December 2023.

It was only after the final whistle he revealed the poignant family anniversary he was marking.

Grealish was four years of age when brother Keelan died in April

2000, aged just nine months due to Sudden Infant Death Syndrome (SIDS).

The England midfielder spoke about the anniversary of Keelan’s death when talking to Sky Sports after the game.

“My little brother passed away 25 years ago today,” he said. “This day is hard on the family.

“My mum and dad were here, so to score and to win was brilliant.”

Grealish later paid a tribute on Instagram, external, writing: “With me always especially this day ... that was for you Keelan.”

City manager Pep Guardiola said he was unaware of the anniversary but paid tribute to Grealish’s compassionate nature. The 29-year-old has a sister, Holly, 21, who has cerebral palsy.

“Jack is an incredible human being,” said Guardiola. “He is incredibly generous.

“I didn’t know that and I can’t imagine how tough it can be with mum and dad and sister. It is good they remember him, this day. I am sure they remember him every single day. But it is good to score.”

It remains to be seen whether Grealish’s selection in the number 10 role was because Guardiola was resting key players - such as Phil Foden and Kevin de Bruyne - for Sunday’s Manchester derby at Old

Trafford when City will look to avenge United’s victory at the Etihad in December.

However, this was a useful opportunity for Grealish to push his claims for a regular starting spot in a team that has misfired badly this season and is now facing at least five weeks without its main goal threat in Erling Haaland, who is injured.

The belief is that Grealish, who has two years left on his contract, will decide his future in the summer, as Guardiola prepares for another very extensive recruitment campaign for his team, potentially either side of the Club World Cup in June and July.

Guardiola did not feel Grealish played at the same level against Leicester in the number 10 position as he did in his usual left-side role against Championship strugglers Plymouth in the FA Cup fifth round last month.

“He is comfortable playing on the side but he likes to play in the middle because he used to play free,” said the City boss. “He has ability to control the ball and pass between the lines.

“I know it is not easy when you don’t play regularly. He was really good against Plymouth, much better than today, but I am happy for him. It is not easy for the people in the middle when they defend low.”



Max Verstappen passes fans in the centre grandstand during qualifying for the 2024 Austrian GP KYM ILLMAN

What’s it like being a replacement F1 driver for Verstappen?

Yuki Tsunoda was promoted from Racing Bulls to the Red Bull team- This is the sort of debut he would have dreamed about.

GARY ROSE

► Japan

Yuki Tsunoda will race for Red Bull for the first time in front of his home fans at this weekend’s Japanese Grand Prix.

But alongside the sense of pride there will likely also be feelings of

uncertainty and pressure on the 24-year-old, after he was promoted to replace Liam Lawson just two races into the season. Lawson was demoted after crashing out of the season opener in Australia and then qualifying last for both the Sprint and Grand Prix in China week later.

Tsunoda, meanwhile, steps up

from the junior F1 team. “It’s a mixed feeling,” he told BBC Radio 5 live. “But even with the pressure and challenge you’ll only experience that situation ever, maybe once or twice in life so overall I excited.”

Tsunoda will have a lot to learn in a short space of time.

He may be only 24 but is an expe-

rienced F1 driver, having been racing since 2021 with AlphaTauri and RB - now Racing Bulls - last season.

But having spent pre-season familiarising with the Racing Bulls car he will now quickly have to learn how to handle Red Bull’s RB21.

He says he has spent plenty of time in the simulator, but nothing can match the experience of driving it for real.

“I think getting into any new car is not easy but at the same time I drove already the simulator car quite well, it’s close enough to feel the car,” Tsunoda said.

“I know the direction I want to have in terms of car set-up, it still works quite well when I tried in simulator and I’m sure I’ll start in a direction more towards that.”

In addition, he will have to quickly build a relationship with his new race engineer and team-mate Max Verstappen that the rest of the field will already have.

“I think Yuki has nothing to lose”, says his partner, Verstappen.